Naghmeh (Melody) Nazar

FALL 2027 PHD APPLICANT | SPEECH ML | MULTIMODAL & TRUSTWORTHY AI

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RESEARCH FOCUS

Fall 2027 PhD applicant with an M.S. in Computer Engineering and completed research in speech emotion recognition. Developed a four-class 2D ResNet-inspired CNN on RAVDESS and TESS, achieving 80.36% validation accuracy and 74.4% on a held-out mixed test set, with explicit limits on speaker-independent and cross-corpus claims. Broader interests include speech and multimodal learning, trustworthy and robust machine learning, affective computing, human-centered AI, and the safety of emerging AI systems. Brings 3+ years of production software engineering experience to building testable research systems.

Research interests: speech processing, multimodal learning, trustworthy and robust machine learning, affective computing, human-centered AI, AI safety

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

M.S. Thesis - Speech Emotion Recognition, CSUN **Aug 2026**

- Developed a four-class 2D ResNet-inspired CNN on RAVDESS and TESS using 16 kHz audio and 128 x 128 log-Mel spectrograms.
- On the current mixed-corpus split, achieved 80.36% validation accuracy and 74.4% held-out test accuracy; the split does not establish speaker-independent or cross-corpus generalization.
- Desktop latency and naturalistic-speech generalization remain unmeasured; no deployment or clinical-validation claim is made.

RESEARCH OUTPUTS & PRESENTATION

- M.S. thesis - "Real-Time Speech Emotion Recognition Using Optimized Deep Residual Networks," California State University, Northridge, Aug 2026. PDF available on request.
- Presenter - 40th Annual CSU Student Research Competition: M.S. speech emotion recognition research, 2026. Presentation materials available on request.

SELECTED ENGINEERING PROJECT

GenAI Email & Scheduling Agent **2026**

- Built an n8n workflow combining email classification, response generation, and scheduling across OpenAI, Gmail, and Airtable. github.com/nzrnaghme/RespondEmailAgent
- Documented validation and human-approval boundaries for generated messages and calendar actions.

EDUCATION

M.S. in Computer Engineering, California State University, Northridge **Aug 2024 - Aug 2026**

Thesis advisor: Prof. Shahnam Mirzaei

B.S. in Computer Engineering, University of Science and Technology of Mazandaran **Aug 2016 - Mar 2021**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Developer, Golrang Industrial Group - Tehran, Iran **Jul 2022 - Jul 2024**

- Architected cross-platform applications with React Native and React.js PWA; contributed UI implementation, state management, caching, performance optimization, and code review.

React Developer, Erole.ir - Tehran, Iran **Jun 2021 - Jun 2022**

- Built React and Redux applications and integrated REST APIs and SignalR-based real-time features.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Speech and machine learning: Python, TensorFlow, Keras, scikit-learn, NumPy, Pandas, 2D CNN/ResNet, log-Mel spectrograms, MFCCs

Research and evaluation: experimental design, error analysis, cross-corpus evaluation, reproducible workflows

Engineering: C++, JavaScript, TypeScript, n8n, React, React Native, Node.js, REST APIs, Git, Linux